

A Trio CloudEdge FIELD GUIDE

Is Your Cloud Migration Quietly Setting You Up To Fail?

14 Uncomfortable Questions Every IT Leader
Should Ask Before And During A Cloud Move.
Each One Comes With The Exact Technical Fix
Our Engineers Use In The Field.

14 Pain Points

14 Direct Fixes



devopstrio.co.uk



info@devopstrioglobal.com



PAIN POINT 01 MIGRATION OVERLOAD

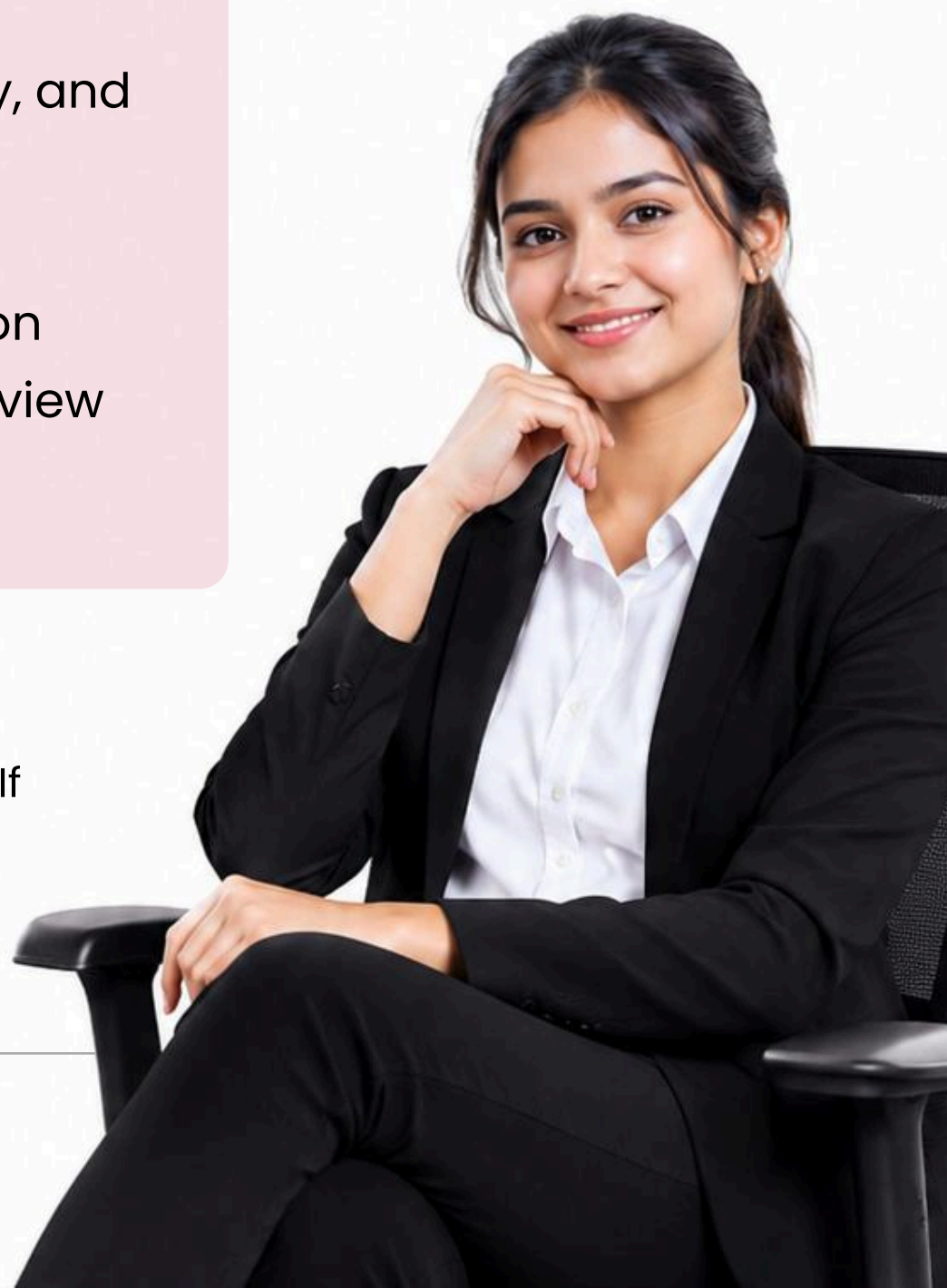
How many of your "cloud migration" projects have quietly become a cost overrun with no rollback plan?

Most enterprises underestimate how overwhelming migration actually is. Teams dive in without ever scoring which applications are even fit for the cloud, and a "quick move" turns into a half-finished deployment nobody wants to own or worse, permanent vendor lock-in.

FIX IT

Before a single Terraform module gets written, **run a workload suitability scorecard**. Score every application on business criticality, technical complexity, compliance sensitivity, and dependency depth. Anything that scores "high complexity + high criticality" doesn't enter a migration wave until it has its own design review no exceptions.

Ask yourself: **could you produce this scorecard for your top 5 apps right now?** If not, you don't have a migration plan you have a moving date.



PAIN POINT 02 — THE LEGACY COLLISION

Do you actually know how much data this migration needs to move or are you guessing?

Legacy systems, data gravity, and compliance obligations make migrations far more complex than they look on a slide. Teams routinely underestimate transfer volumes and network changes, then compress everything into a rushed timeline because a data centre lease or hardware contract is expiring.



A rushed timeline doesn't make data move faster. **It just moves the failure closer to launch day.**

FIX IT

Run a **data gravity assessment** before you scope a single deadline. Map every application's data dependencies and daily transfer volume first. Then reverse-engineer your cutover date from real bandwidth math not from when your hardware happens to get decommissioned.

PAIN POINT 03 THE LIFT-AND-SHIFT TRAP

If you "lift and shift" this app tomorrow, does your cloud bill go up or down in month one?

The most common migration mistake is blindly lifting an app into a cloud VM and expecting instant savings or agility. It usually delivers the opposite: higher bills, worse performance, and hidden costs in bandwidth and licensing that nobody priced in because nobody ran a proof of concept first.

FIX IT

Before any rehost, run a **2-week proof of concept** on a non-critical workload at the target sizing, and cost it with a TCO calculator that includes bandwidth and licensing — not just compute. If the POC doesn't show a real path to savings, you refactor or retire the app. You don't lift it.

"Cloud-ready" isn't a checkbox. **It's a number you can show your CFO before, not after, go-live.**

03

PAIN POINT 04 — THE MISSING STRATEGY

Could you defend your migration strategy for this app in one sentence or is it just "move it and see"?

"One-size-fits-all" almost never works across SaaS, IaaS, and PaaS workloads with different security requirements. Without an explicit strategy per application, teams default to the path of least resistance which is usually the wrong one.



If nobody can name the "R" for an app, **nobody has actually decided how it's moving.**

FIX IT

Use AWS's **7 Rs framework** Retire, Retain, Rehost, Replatform, Refactor, Relocate, Repurchase and build a one-page decision matrix per application, signed off by the app owner. No workload enters a migration wave without an assigned "R."

PAIN POINT 05 — THE COST SHOCK

Have you priced what happens to your bill the day this migration actually goes live?

Bandwidth, egress, and licensing costs rarely show up in the original business case. They surface on the first invoice after go-live right when leadership is asking whether the migration was worth it.

FIX IT

Tag every resource with a cost center and workload ID from day one, and set a budget alert at 80% of projected spend before cutover — not after the invoice already shocked someone in Finance.

If cost visibility starts on invoice day, **it started about a month too late.**

05

PAIN POINT 06 — COMPLIANCE BLIND SPOTS

If a regulator asked where this dataset physically lives right now, could you answer in ten seconds?

Compliance requirements are one of the biggest complicating factors in any migration, yet data residency is rarely mapped with the same rigor as the network architecture. That gap is exactly where audits go wrong.



Test environments are where residency violations quietly happen first. **Map them too.**

FIX IT

Build a **data residency map** alongside your architecture diagram every dataset tagged with geography, classification, and retention rule before it is copied anywhere, including test environments.

PAIN POINT 07 — THE BIG-BANG CUTOVER

What's your rollback plan if this cutover fails at 2am?

Switching everything over at once with no gates, no rehearsal, no rollback trigger is still one of the most common ways migrations turn into outages. It usually happens because the "plan" was really just a date on a calendar.

FIX IT

Design **blue-green or canary cutovers** with explicit validation gates: dev/ test → staging validation → final cutover each gate with a named rollback trigger and a named owner who can pull it.

"We'll figure out rollback if we need it" **is not a rollback plan.**

07

PAIN POINT 08 — VENDOR LOCK-IN

Could you move this workload to another provider in under six months if you had to?

Mismatched workload types and rushed platform choices quietly create dependency on proprietary services. Nobody notices until a contract renegotiation or an outage forces the question.



Lock-in isn't the mistake. **Not knowing you're locked in that's the mistake.**

FIX IT

For any workload above medium criticality, document an **exit strategy before go-live**: what's proprietary, what's portable, and what a re platform would actually cost. Treat it like insurance you hope never to use.

PAIN POINT 09 — THE IDENTITY AFTERTHOUGHT

Is your tenant really secure once this migration is live or was identity bolted on at the end?

Security and identity teams are too often looped in during the final week, after new cloud accounts, roles, and access paths already exist. Every account created during a migration is new attack surface and attackers know migrations create exactly this kind of gap.

FIX IT

Bring identity and security architecture into the plan on **day one**. Enforce least-privilege IAM roles, conditional access, and MFA on every new cloud account before a single workload lands in it not after go-live.

Go check right now: **how many new cloud accounts from this migration still don't have MFA enforced?**

09

PAIN POINT 10 — THE SKIPPED PILOT

Which non-critical app have you actually migrated end-to-end or is this all still theoretical?

Skipping a pilot means your tools and process are being validated for the first time on a production-critical workload. That's an expensive place to discover a gap in your playbook.



A playbook that's never been run remains a theory, **not a reliable plan.**

FIX IT

Pilot on **one low-risk application first**. Measure real performance and cost against your pre-migration baseline, and only scale the same playbook to critical workloads once the pilot numbers hold up.

PAIN POINT 11 — NO INFRASTRUCTURE AS CODE

If your migration environment vanished tonight, could your team rebuild it by morning?

Manually built environments drift the moment someone makes a "quick fix" through the console. By the time something breaks, nobody can say with confidence what the environment actually looks like anymore.

FIX IT

Define every environment in **Terraform or Bicep** from the very first dev/ test build. Reproducibility isn't a nice-to-have here a fully codified environment is your real rollback plan.

If it's not in code, **it's not documented it's just remembered by one person on your team.**

11

PAIN POINT 12 — THE TEAM READINESS GAP

Who on your team can actually handle a production incident in this new environment at 3am?

Handing production over to a team that's never operated the new environment is how a routine migration turns into a multi-hour outage during the very first incident.



The first incident in a new environment **is not the time to be learning the environment.**

FIX IT

Run a formal **cloud-ops handover** before cutover: monitoring dashboards built, incident response runbooks written, and an on-call rotation trained and tested before any production traffic moves.

PAIN POINT 13 — THE OPTIMIZATION NOBODY OWNS

Is anyone actually revisiting this migration 90 days after go-live or did everyone just move on?

Most teams treat "go-live" as the finish line. But the biggest savings and the biggest security fixes usually surface only after real production traffic hits the new environment.

FIX IT

Schedule a **mandatory 90-day optimization review**: right-size every VM, swap self-managed services for managed equivalents (RDS instead of self-hosted DB, Blob Storage instead of self-hosted storage), and refactor the highest-cost components first.

Go-live is the midpoint of a migration, **not the finish line**.

13

FINAL QUESTION

So is your migration actually ready, or just underway?

Run through this checklist honestly. If more than two boxes are unchecked, your next cutover has a real chance of becoming an incident.

☐ Cataloged every workload in scope

☐ Cataloged every workload in scope

☐ Landing zone (network + accounts) is live

☐ Identity & MFA enforced before workloads land

☐ Failback scenario tested, not just documented

☐ Smoke tests run immediately after data sync

☐ Cost alerts set before cutover, not after

☐ 90-day optimization review on the calendar

TECHNICAL NEXT STEP

Start with the 2-week POC framework from Page 04, applied to one non-critical workload this month, not next quarter.

STRATEGIC NEXT STEP

Book a free migration health check with Devopstrio's CloudCraft team: a workload assessment, a 7 Rs matrix, and a tenant security gap report before your next cutover.

THANK YOU !

We hope these insights help you build a faster, safer, and more successful cloud migration journey.

CALL TO ACTION

Ready to Make Your Cloud Migration a Success?

- ✓ **Free Cloud Migration Health Check**
- ✓ **Workload Assessment & 7Rs Strategy**
- ✓ **Security & Compliance Review**
- ✓ **Cost Optimization Recommendations**

Let's build a migration strategy that delivers results not surprises.



devopstrio.co.uk



info@devopstrioglobal.com

**Innovate
Deliver
Impact**